



REPUBLIC OF CAMEROON – PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA

Academic Cooperation for Innovation, Artificial Intelligence and Sustainable Development



**GLOBAL COMPETITION ON DESIGN
FOR FUTURES (GCD4F)**

CAMEROON STUDENT COORDINATION

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喀麦隆共和国 — 中华人民共和国

创新、人工智能与可持续发展学术合作

全球未来设计大赛 (GCD4F)

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NATIONAL CALL FOR PROJECTS

GUIDE TO PARTICIPATING IN THE GLOBAL COMPETITION ON DESIGN FOR FUTURES (GCD4F) 2026 IN CAMEROON

The **Global Competition on Design for Futures (GCD4F) 2026** is an international academic competition initiated by **Beijing Normal University**, in collaboration with the **UNESCO Institute for Information Technologies in Education (UNESCO IITE)** and the **World Digital Education Alliance**. This initiative aims to mobilize students worldwide to develop innovative solutions to major contemporary challenges through **design, artificial intelligence, and technological innovation**. The competition offers students an international platform to design innovative solutions that contribute to the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** through the use of emerging technologies and interdisciplinary approaches. In Cameroon, with the support of the **Minister of State, Minister of Higher Education**, and representing the participation of Cameroonian universities, the competition is open to **students regardless of their level or academic program (Bachelor's, Master's, and Doctorate/Engineering)**.

1. Team composition

To participate, students must form a team of **3 to 5 members**. Team members can be from the same or different universities/faculties/schools/programs. However, **interdisciplinary teams are strongly encouraged**. An important requirement : At least **one team member must be able to communicate in English**. This is mandatory because all submissions must be in English and presentations will be conducted in English.

2. Official language of the competition

The official language of the competition is **English** for all submitted materials: project report, presentation video, pitch for the finals, and presentation slides. Even if the team works locally in French, the **final submission must be in English**.

3. Competition Themes

Each team must propose a project in **one of the following three thematic areas**.

✓ AI for Science

Applications of artificial intelligence to improve scientific research, health, energy, climate, sustainable technologies.



✓ **AI for Education**

Solutions using artificial intelligence to improve learning, transform teaching methods, promote inclusive education, and support students in difficulty.

✓ **AI for Society**

Technological solutions aimed at addressing societal challenges such as mental health, digital inclusion, governance, sustainable cities, and citizen participation.

4. Project Format

- ✓ Projects can take many forms : digital application or platform, technological prototype, artificial intelligence-based solution, educational device, and social innovation solution using technology.
- ✓ Each project must demonstrate a clearly identified problem, an innovative solution, a potential impact on society, and a possibility of real implementation.

5. Application file

To participate in the first phase, each team must submit:

- ✓ **A project report** : A document presenting the problem studied, the proposed solution, the technology used, and the social or scientific impact.
- ✓ **A presentation video** : A video of approximately 5 minutes presenting the team, the idea of the project, the proposed solution.

6. The phases of the competition

The competition takes place in three main phases.

Phase 1 : Initial Submission (Online, from March 9 to April 19, 2026)

Teams must register for the competition, develop their project, and submit a report and video. The projects are then evaluated by an **international jury**.

Phase 2 : Regional Finals (In person, mid-May 2026)

The pre-selected teams improve their project and present their solution during the **regional finals (Africa zone)** scheduled to take place in Cameroon at the National Advanced School of Engineering / University of Yaoundé 1 (NASEY).

Phase 3 : World Final (In person, in October 2026)

The best teams participate in the **world final** where they will present their solutions to an international jury. The world final can be held **in Beijing or Paris**.

7. Evaluation Criteria

Projects are evaluated according to the following criteria : Understanding of the problem, innovation of the solution, responsible use of technology and AI, potential social or scientific impact, quality of the presentation.

8. Important Information

- ✓ Participation in the competition is **free**.
- ✓ Teams can be supported by **mentors**.
- ✓ A **prototype or demonstration** is recommended when possible.
- ✓ The selected projects may **be published in an international academic collection**.

9. Opportunities for participants

Participating teams can benefit from several opportunities:

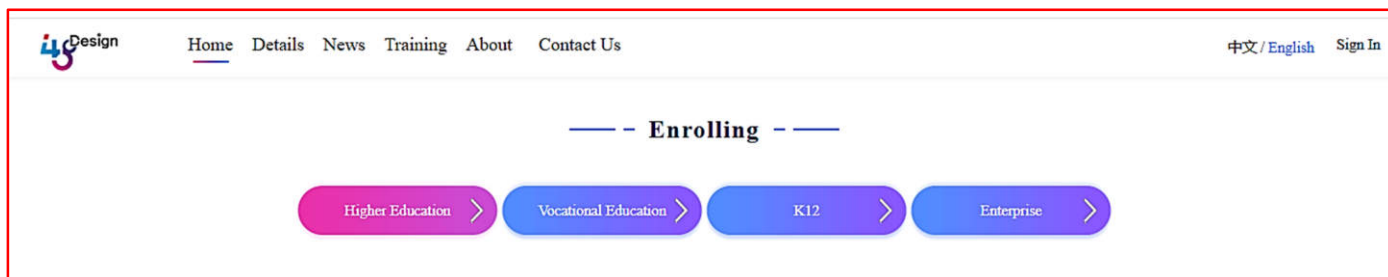
- ✓ International certificates
- ✓ International academic visibility
- ✓ Publication of selected projects
- ✓ Participation in international conferences
- ✓ Opportunities for academic collaboration and internships
- ✓ International academic recognition.

10. Why participate ?

The GCD4F enables students to develop skills **in innovation and design**, work on **real technological projects**, collaborate with students from around the world, contribute to the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**, and represent their university and country on an **international stage**.

11. Official competition links

- ✓ Official website of the competition : <https://gcd4fe.bnu.edu.cn/en/index.html>
- ✓ Official presentation : <https://gcd4fe.bnu.edu.cn/en/detail/index.html>



12. Coordination in Cameroon

Interested students in Cameroon can contact the **GCD4F Cameroon Student Coordination Office** to receive registration information, be supported in forming teams and prepare their project for the competition.



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